Thursday, May 11

No truce yet.

The social resentment of the Mizrahim has bothered me for a long time. On the one hand, I do not like the political options of Shas; on the other hand, I know that the—often automatic and unconscious—rejection which the Mizrahim have suffered was real. It is true that in some of the most demanding functions in the army one didn't find many Mizrahim for a long time, because those who became pilots, for example, had to show abilities that most Mizrahi candidates had not yet acquired. I am not sure whether, nowadays, the situation is more balanced. The protest of the air force mechanics, several weeks ago, that they were second-class citizens was unjustified because probably nobody considered them as such, but it was justified in their own eyes, because the most prestigious positions in the air force were not yet equally theirs. And, as I mentioned before, among part of the ultra-Orthodox, the rejection of Mizrahim by their *yeshivot* was conscious and voluntary.

Friday, May 12

For what is this whole thing good, except for consolidating— temporarily— Netanyahu's coalition? Islamic Jihad is not an organization of choirboys, and in the event of real conflict, there would be no reason not to deal with them as severely as necessary. But at this moment, for nothing? Incidentally, it is interesting to see that Hamas abstains from joining the fray. It wants to spare the civilian population for which it is responsible, while Jihad is exclusively fixated on the military struggle against Israel. The whole episode would be ridiculous, were it not for the civilian victims on both sides.